SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 315

In Memory
of
Ben Clark Jr.

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas joins the citizens of Dallas in mourning the loss of Ben Clark Jr., who died September 17, 2026, at the age of 82; and

WHEREAS, Born in Ferriday, Louisiana, on December 9, 1943, Ben Clark Jr. distinguished himself for his work ethic, intellect, and sense of justice from an early age and graduated as valedictorian of Sevier High School; and

WHEREAS, While attending Southern University and A&M College, he served as student body president, pledged Omega Psi Phi Fraternity, competed on the football and track teams, and courageously registered Black voters as a member of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee and the Southern Christian Leadership Council; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Clark furthered his education at the Ohio College of Podiatric Medicine, and after completing his residency, he moved to Dallas with his family and established a podiatry practice in Oak Cliff, where he assisted patients for more than five decades; and

WHEREAS, A trailblazer in his profession, Dr. Clark served as chief of podiatry at Saint Paul Hospital and Methodist Dallas Medical Center; he was a founding member and president of the National Podiatric Medical Association and also the first Black president of the Texas State Board of Podiatric Medical Examiners and the Texas Podiatric Medical Association; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Clark's leadership and commitment to service extended to many other aspects of his community; he served as founding chairman of Sunbelt National Bank, and he further contributed to the civic life of Dallas as a member of the City Planning Commission and numerous charitable organizations; and

WHEREAS, A man of abiding faith, Dr. Clark shared 57 years of marriage with his beloved wife, Jennifer, and he took great pride in his children, his grandchildren, and his large extended family; and

WHEREAS, Through his pioneering medical career, his advocacy for equality, and his enduring devotion to his community, Dr. Ben Clark Jr. leaves behind a legacy that will continue to inspire all those who were privileged to know him; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby extend sincere condolences to the bereaved family of Ben Clark Jr.; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for his family as an expression of deepest sympathy from the Texas Senate.

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate